

NestPaw Fulfillment Pipeline

End-to-end operating guide: buy wholesale stock, publish sellable inventory, take the Stripe order, pack, buy a USPS label on Pirate Ship, mark shipped, and send the customer tracking email. Week-1 model is **self-ship from your NestPaw U.S. ship-from address** (Pirate Ship + USPS Ground Advantage). No 3PL yet.

STORE	ADMIN	CARRIER	EMAIL
shopnestpaw.com Next.js · Stripe · Neon	/admin/orders /admin/inventory	USPS Ground Advantage via Pirate Ship	orders@shopnestpaw.com via Resend

Buy stock → Receive & QA → Log purchase → Set stock → Sync storefront
Customer checkout (Stripe) → Webhook creates order → Stock decrements
Admin: unfulfilled → Pick / pack + tips card → Pirate Ship label → USPS
Mark shipped + tracking → Resend email → Customer receives (5–8 days)

0 · Locked defaults

Lever	Choice
Market	United States only
Supply	Alibaba / CJ samples first → Alibaba bulk for winners
Payments	Stripe Checkout (live mode on production)
Database	Postgres (Neon on Vercel)
Fulfillment	Self-ship week 1; 3PL only if volume later requires it
Customer shipping	\$5.50 under \$40 · free over \$40
Postage target	Keep single-item Ground Advantage near \$5.50; free-shipping carts funded by margin
Site promise	Ships within 24 hours · arrives in 5–8 business days · 30-day returns

1 · Buy stock (wholesale)

Start here every time you need inventory — before anything can sell on the storefront.

1. Open the product catalog: **business/pdfs/nestpaw-product-catalog.pdf** (sell prices, Alibaba costs, supplier links).
2. Choose SKUs to order (samples first; bulk only after a product converts).
3. Place the order on **Alibaba** or **CJ** to your NestPaw ship-from / warehouse address.
4. Save the supplier invoice / order confirmation for cost tracking.
5. In NestPaw admin, log the purchase under **Inventory** → **Purchases** (vendor, items, quantities, costs, lead time, MOQ).

Catalog SKUs: Shedding Brush Kit (\$29) · Forage Snuffle Mat (\$44) · Silicone Slow Feeder Mat (\$29) · Quiet Nail Grinder (\$29) · Suction Lick Mat (\$14). Kits use warehouse parts (brush kit = deshedding brush + grooming glove).

2 · Receive, QA, and publish stock

2a · Physical receive & QA

1. When the carton arrives, count units against the purchase order.
2. Inspect each sample/SKU for quality, sizing vs storefront photos, pack contents (brush + glove for the kit; USB cable for the nail grinder), and real package weight/dimensions for accurate Pirate Ship rates.
3. Set aside defective units — do not publish them as storefront stock.

2b · Update warehouse inventory

1. Open <https://shopnestpaw.com/admin/inventory>.
2. Set **warehouse stock** for each part/SKU to the sellable count after QA.
3. For kits, ensure component parts have stock (kit availability is derived from parts).

2c · Sync to storefront

1. Use **Sync to storefront** so storefront stock matches what customers may buy.
2. On <https://shopnestpaw.com/shop>, confirm in-stock items show counts and sold-out items cannot be added to cart.

Customers can only buy **storefront stock**. Warehouse stock alone does not sell. Always sync after receiving inventory.

3 · Prep the packing station (before first sale)

Item	Why
Poly mailers and/or small boxes	Primary packaging
Packing paper / filler	Prevent rattle and bend damage
Packing tape	Seal boxes / reinforce mailers
Return-address labels	NestPaw ship-from address (also set in Pirate Ship)
Printed calm tips cards	Artwork: store/public/packaging/nestpaw-calm-tips-card.png
Scale	Accurate Pirate Ship weight (phone scale fine at first)
Printer	Print Pirate Ship labels (thermal optional later)
Spare USB cables	Required for Quiet Nail Grinder orders

Pirate Ship account, payment method, and one refunded test label should already be done.

4 · Customer places the order

1. Customer browses shopnestpaw.com → product page → cart → checkout.
2. NestPaw checkout shows the order summary and redirects to **Stripe Checkout**. Stripe collects email, phone, shipping address, and payment — NestPaw does not collect email on its own checkout page.
3. Stripe charges the card and can send the customer a Stripe receipt (if enabled in Dashboard).
4. You get a payment notification via the Stripe mobile app (successful payments + payouts).

5 · Order lands in NestPaw (automatic)

1. Stripe fires **checkout.session.completed** to <https://shopnestpaw.com/api/stripe-webhook>.
2. NestPaw verifies the webhook signature, then creates/updates the customer, creates the order with line items + shipping address, sets fulfillment to **unfulfilled**, and **decrements storefront stock** for paid items.
3. Order appears in [/admin/orders](#).

If an order never appears after a real paid checkout, the webhook failed — check Stripe Dashboard → Developers → Webhooks, then Vercel / Neon. Do not ship from a Stripe payment alone without an admin order.

6 · Pull the order in admin

1. Open <https://shopnestpaw.com/admin/orders> (bookmark this).
2. Open the **unfulfilled** order in the detail view.
3. Confirm products, quantity, customer email, and the full shipping address (name, phone, street, city, state, ZIP, apartment).
4. Keep the order tab open — you will paste tracking here after the label.

7 · Pick and pack

1. Pull the exact SKU(s) from physical inventory.
2. Quick QA again: no damage, correct item, complete kit parts.
3. Add **one dog calm tips card** to every package.
4. Pack with enough filler so the item cannot rattle or bend.
5. Seal the package; apply a return-address label if the carrier label does not already print one.

Product	Must pack with
Shedding Brush Kit	Deshedding brush, grooming glove, tips card
Forage Snuffle Mat	Snuffle mat, tips card
Silicone Slow Feeder Mat	Slow-feeder mat, tips card
Quiet Nail Grinder	Grinder, USB cable, tips card
Suction Lick Mat	Lick mat, tips card

8 · Buy the shipping label (Pirate Ship)

1. Create a new shipment in **Pirate Ship**.
2. Confirm ship-from = NestPaw return / warehouse address.
3. Paste the customer address from admin (double-check ZIP and apartment).
4. Enter real package weight and dimensions from the scale / ruler.
5. Choose **USPS Ground Advantage** (default week-1 service).
6. Buy the label and print it.
7. Affix the label flat without covering any barcodes.

Target: single-item Ground Advantage postage near the **\$5.50** flat rate customers pay. Free-shipping carts (\$40+) are funded by product margin. If postage runs high, re-check weight/dimensions and prefer a poly mailer.

9 · Hand off to USPS

1. Drop at a USPS retail counter, collection box (if label rules allow), or scheduled pickup.
2. Keep the Pirate Ship confirmation / receipt until the package shows a first scan.
3. Aim to ship within **24 hours** of payment when stock is on hand (matches storefront copy).

10 · Mark shipped in NestPaw (triggers customer email)

1. Return to the order detail page: `/admin/orders/[orderId]`.
2. Set fulfillment status to **shipped**.
3. Paste the **tracking number** (required — email will not send without it).
4. Save.
5. Confirm the admin banner shows shipping email as **sent** (not “needs tracking”, “unchanged”, or error).

NestPaw then emails the customer from **NestPaw <orders@shopnestpaw.com>** (“Your NestPaw order is on its way”) with greeting, order id, tracking, USPS link, timing note, and Contact.

Same status + same tracking does **not** resend. Change tracking to force a new send, or email the customer yourself.

11 · Delivery and aftercare

1. Watch for first USPS scan (usually same day or next business day).
2. Most U.S. deliveries arrive in about **5 to 8 business days** after the package is shipped.
3. Questions and return requests come through <https://shopnestpaw.com/contact>, land in your CONTACT_TO_EMAIL inbox via Resend, and set reply-to to the customer.
4. Handle returns in admin (return status) + Stripe refunds when needed.
5. Honor the 30-day return window for unused items in original condition.

12 · Soft-launch test order (run once when stock arrives)

1. Set live storefront stock in /admin/inventory and sync.
2. Place one real paid order to yourself on production (full price, or a small \$1 test if you prefer).
3. Confirm Stripe charge → webhook → admin order → stock drop.
4. Pack, buy label, ship, then mark shipped with tracking.
5. Confirm the branded shipping email arrives from orders@shopnestpaw.com.
6. Refund the test order in Stripe when done.
7. Soft-launch to friends/family (or a small ad) and fulfill with this pipeline.

Troubleshooting quick reference

Problem	What to do
Paid order missing from admin	Check Stripe webhook delivery + Neon; confirm live webhook secret on Vercel
Shop out of stock but warehouse has units	Publish / sync storefront stock in /admin/inventory
Address looks wrong	Email the customer before buying postage
Tracking email did not send	Need status=shipped AND tracking filled; check Resend for orders@
Postage much over \$5.50	Re-check weight/dimensions; try a poly mailer; note for pricing
Package damaged in transit	Ask for photos within 7 days; replace or refund per policy
Contact form not arriving	Confirm RESEND_API_KEY + CONTACT_FROM/TO_EMAIL in Vercel

Related docs: README.md · business/PACK-SHIP.md · TODO.md · business/pdfs/nestpaw-product-catalog.pdf. Revise this PDF if fulfillment later moves to a 3PL.